02 Licensing

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Pro tips

• Teams Phone lets a user be an enterprise voice user. A Calling Plan is Microsoft acting as the carrier, bought separately.

• An auto attendant or call queue resource account usually needs a free virtual-user license, not a Calling Plan, unless that app places outbound calls.

• Teams Premium does not include Teams Phone or a phone number.

Interview traps

• Buying a Calling Plan and expecting Direct Routing to start working.

• Licensing every resource account with a Calling Plan because the queue has a phone number.

Cheat sheet

Teams Phone user can be enterprise voice

Calling Plan Microsoft is the PSTN carrier

Operator Connect carrier operates, you assign

Phone Mobile mobile operator

Direct Routing you operate the SBC

Resource account its own license, not the agent's

Teams Premium not a phone system

Facts in the long lessons were checked 14 October 2026. This sheet is a memory aid.

Sources and go deeper

- Teams Phone licensing — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Set up Teams Phone — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Calling Plans — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Microsoft 365 — Wikipedia — last checked 2026-10. Wikipedia fallback for background. Confirm the vendor page before you change a tenant.

- Microsoft Teams blog index — Community — last checked 2026-10. Community index for the Microsoft Teams blog. This is the index, not a claim that a post discusses this room.
- PSTN connectivity options — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Teams add-on licensing — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Teams Phone Resource Account licenses — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Voice app prerequisites and licensing — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Manage resource accounts — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Plan Direct Routing — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.

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